

DESERT WHISPERS



BUSINESS OF THE MONTH

The Pettus' moved to the desert in 1956 before there was a Christmas Valley. Around 1960 the last large cattle drive went through town. Mrs. Pettus has a picture of them at the site which is now the Christmas Valley Lodge. There were approximately 7,000 cattle in the drive.

Mrs. Pettus' Father homesteaded here at the turn of the Century. In 1956 uranium was discovered some place in Lake County and Mrs. Pettus' Father wanted to check over his property so Milt Beckett and John Pettus came from Grand Junction, Colorado and met Mr. Beckett in Lakeview and they came up to look at his property. The property is located just over the hill from Century Ranch which was in production and looked green and gorgeous. So John Pettus went to Lakeview and bought 320 acres from Chris Langslet. The 320 was located out by View Point. They moved out here the first day of November 1956. The year the power was brought to the Valley. Their closest neighbor was 17 miles away.

View Point had only 160 acres of alfalfa that was irrigated only for the summer. No one lived there except for the summer months.

The winter of 1959-60 Mrs. Pettus had to go to Bend during the week to send her daughters to school.

The spring of 1960 Phil Pittman, the original owner of Century Ranch met her on the street and had a manila folder in his hand and he said "I have sold the desert" and he had.

In the fall of 1960 Penn Phillips started the Lodge. They had a New Years party in the Lodge New Years Eve 1960. The Lodge was absolute center of attraction and everyone had fun. Pettus's moved into one of the first houses built in Christmas Valley in the spring of 1961. The first rodeo was held in 1961.

Evelyn Pettus became a Real Estate salesman in 1964 and a broker in 1967. The Laundromat and office was opened in 1962 or 1963.

CHRISTMAS VALLEY BOARDS

CHRISTMAS VALLEY PARK & RECREATION DISTRICT

A Letter from the Christmas Valley Water Dept. was read stating that a monthly fee of \$11.00 per month will be charged for the Community Hall.

A motion was made and seconded to give the pool table in the Community Hall back to Henry Jensen.

It was decided to charge \$1.00 per hour for the use of the Community Hall.

A motion was made and seconded to have the Water Dept. fix the faucets at the Rodeo Grounds and bill the Park & Rec.

CHRISTMAS VALLEY RURAL FIRE PROTECTION DISTRICT

Elwood Palmer's resignation from the Christmas Valley Fire Dept. Board of Directors was read at the last meeting.

It was decided that the movie projector would be used only for training films for the Volunteer Firemen. Any equipment taken from the Fire Hall must be signed for on the sign-out sheet in the Fire Dept. Office and returned.

It was decided to return Fred Johnson's bid on the Chevy Utility Truck since it isn't feasible to sell it until we have more useable equipment.

The gas tank for the Fire Dept. has been bought and will be installed.

It was decided that the Volunteer Firemen will have one drill per month on Saturday if they wish.

CHRISTMAS VALLEY WATER DEPT.

The Christmas Valley Fire Department was burglarized recently, according to Margaret Spry, Fire Department Board Chairman. The Christmas Valley Domestic Water District office, which is located in the hall, lost \$330.00, according to Water Board Clerk, Suzanne Johnson. As a result, the Water District will no longer keep cash at the office, Mrs. Johnson said.

AMBULANCE

The Christmas Valley Ambulance made two runs during January and two local residents requested house calls. The EMTs are finalizing their plans for the annual EMT Sweetheart Ball to be held on Saturday, February 14.

This year a "Queen of the Ball" will be crowned at the first intermission. EMT Suzanne Johnson says, "Be sure and cast a vote for your sweetheart at The Trail, The Lodge, Goeres' or Valley Foods."

THE LAST LAUGH -

"A government that robs Peter to pay Paul can always count upon the support of Paul."

George Bernard Shaw

AIRPORT

The Christmas Valley Airport has been chosen to participate in an aircraft activity counter demonstration project, according to Raymond E. Costello, assistant administrator of the Oregon Aeronautics Division. Mr. Costello recently visited the airport to demonstrate the new counting device to be used here. He was accompanied by three members of the Department of Transportation. Mark Ford, Supervisor of Program Development from Salem and John Holcomb and Chuck Strawn both of Bend came to select the best site for the equipment.

Mr. Costello indicated that the recorded activity statistics will be used to help determine if the local airport is in need of state and federal help.

Mr. Ford suggested that the activity counter is expected to come to Christmas Valley in February. It will be here one week out of the month for the next year.

Local volunteers were asked to make weather observations twice daily during the times the activity counter is here. Harold Brockelsby and Percy Cline will be making the observations during the next year.

Desert Inn Motel

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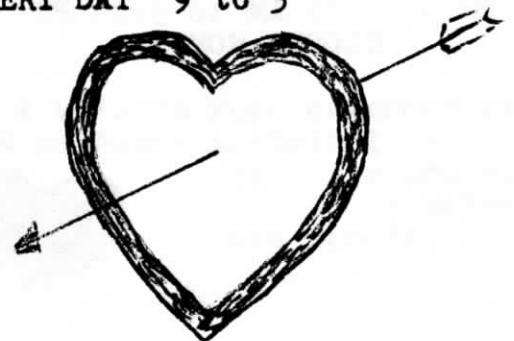
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Christmas Valley, Oregon
97638

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SWEETHEART BALL

The Christmas Valley Emergency Medical Technicians (EMTS) will hold their Third Annual EMT Sweetheart Ball on Saint Valentines Day, Saturday February 14. The Ball, which begins at 9 P.M. in the Community Hall, will feature the music of the Greasewood Flats.

A new feature of the Sweetheart Ball is the EMT Sweetheart Queen contest. Votes may be purchased for 25 cents each or five for a dollar. Votes may be purchased and cast for your favorite lady at the following local businesses: The Trail, The Lodge, Goeres' Grocery and Valley Foods. The votes must be cast by 5 P.M. on the 14th. The Sweetheart getting the most votes will be announced during the first dance intermission. She will be crowned by Bud Maple.

Sweetheart Ball organizer Suzanne Johnson said the new queen contest "is for fun and to help defray the expenses. So come and have fun with us and support your ambulance at the same time."

NEW RESIDENTS

Hank & Beverly De Vries are the new owners of the H & B Lumber & Feed, formerly Discount Lumber, effective January 1st.

Hours - Tuesday thru Saturday 8 AM to 5 PM

They have added feed and will take orders for your needs so they can pick it up on Monday.

TOWN AND COUNTRY

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Opens at Noon

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CLOSED MONDAY

New handmade Rock Jewelry & Belt
Buckles including Absidian & Jasper.
New Dolls & Toys.
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The Lodge

Prime Rib every Friday night.
Home style chicken every Sunday

RESTAURANT HOURS: 6:00 AM to 9:00 PM

LOUNGE HOURS: 11:00 AM to 2:30 AM

Watch for amateur hour in February
with western music.

LIONS CLUB

The Christmas Valley Lions Club is out of debt for the first time since their formation, according to Lion Bud Maple. Some of the Club's sight projects have been very expensive, especially for an infant club's treasury, Mr. Maple said.

Christmas Valley Lions have so far pledged over \$1,500 toward building a new wing at Good Samaritan Hospital. The local campaign is approximately 75% completed. Lion Maple said that statewide the Lions have raised over \$300,000. to date. He indicated the total is better than anticipated.

Future Club plans include selling chances on a rifle. The Lions are now planning their activities for the Fourth of July celebration.

The Lions meet on the second and fourth Tuesdays.

SING WHILE YOU DRIVE

At 45 MPH - Highways are Happy Ways
At 55 MPH - I'm but a stranger here, Heaven is my Home.
At 65 MPH - Nearer My God to Thee.
At 75 MPH - When The Roll is Called Up Yonder I'll be There.
at 85 MPH - "Lord, I'm Coming Home."

GOERES

SUPPORT

THE

EMTS

SWEETHEART



BALL

February

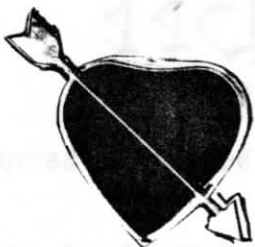
14

9 P.M.

Fun

For

All



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COMMUNITY CHURCH

According to Reverend Cook, the first wedding in the new church will be held on February 28th. The happy couple are Laurie Remy and Stan Adams.

The church is also holding a Sweetheart Banquet at Lakeside Terrace on February 11 at 8 P.M. A fixed menu of Cornish hens will be offered and all are welcome. As yet no price has been set.

AMATEUR FUN NIGHT

The Christmas Valley Lodge will hold an amateur fun night during the month of February, according to Iris Hildebran owner.

The fun night will be for adults only as it will be held in the bar. All persons interested in performing at the fun night should contact the Hildebrans at the Lodge.

The Lodge has been featuring home cooked chicken dinner every Sunday. It goes fast so be there early if you plan to eat some.

HORSE SHOW

Iris Hildebran and Suzanne Johnson are seeking persons interested in organizing a horse show this coming summer. Interested persons should contact Iris or Suzanne.

This paper is published monthly by Christmas Valley Park & Recreation Dept.

Advertising Rates:

- \$ 5.00 for less than 1/4th page
- 10.00 for 1/4th page
- 20.00 for 1/2 page
- 40.00 for full page
- 2.00 for personal greetings - 10 words

Mail ads to:

Desert Whispers
P.O. Box 181
Christmas Valley, Oregon 97633

MEETING DATES:

Christmas Valley Fire Protection Dst.
Second Monday of each Month

Christmas Valley Domestic Water Dept.
Second Wednesday of each Month.

Christmas Valley Park & Recreation
Second Thursday of each Month

COME SEE YOUR BOARDS IN ACTION.

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Open 9 AM - 9 PM, Monday - Saturday
10 AM - 7 PM, Sunday
9 AM - 12 Noon, Holidays

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Feb. 10 - 14 GIANT SALE Hundred of
new items being brought in for
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